

Reserve pawn moves are resources

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

A pawn move can act as a waiting move that changes whose turn it is in a king confrontation. Spending every harmless-looking pawn move too early can leave you in zugzwang later. Keep track of which moves preserve the structure.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If your king has the desired opposition but must move, a safe pawn move on the other wing may force the opponent to yield instead. That pawn move must not create a losing weakness or accelerate an enemy passer.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you record when evaluating a pawn ending?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Useful waiting moves for both sides, including single versus double pawn advances when legal. A tempo that looks spare may be essential to controlling an entry square.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Treat pawn tempi like a limited reserve.